

The [Courtyard by Marriott Tokyo Station](#) is your "Grand Central" base. Located on the **Yaesu side** (the modern, business side) of Tokyo Station, you are in the perfect spot for transit.

The "Newbie" Navigator's Toolkit

- **The "Yaesu" Secret:** Your hotel is near the **Yaesu South Exit**. Tokyo Station is a maze; if you see "Marunouchi," you are on the opposite side of the station. Always follow signs for **Yaesu**.
- **Kyobashi Station:** This is your "secret weapon." It's a **1-minute walk** from your lobby and sits on the **Ginza Line (Yellow)**, which goes directly to Harajuku, Ginza, and Asakusa.
- **7-Eleven:** Located right in your hotel building. It's perfect for the "viral" snack runs at 11:00 PM.
- **Must Download Apps:** SmartEX (Trains), Japan Travel by NAVITIME (Maps), GO (Taxi Dispatch), SUICA in Apple Wallet, Tablelog (Food reviews), TableCheck (Reservations), [Omakase.in](#) (Omakase rez), Ramen Beast (Hidden Ramen spots), Papago (translation app), Payke (for Sadie reading labels), Klook (book activities), NERV (Earthquake/weather).



May 27 (Wed): The Landing & The Underground City

Plan of Attack: After a 14-hour flight, the goal is "Zero Complexity." You land at 3:25 PM. You'll use a private transfer to the hotel, drop your bags, and head into the "Underground City" (Tokyo Station) for a world-class dinner that requires zero outdoor navigation.

- **Logistics:**
 - **Arrival:** Meet your driver at Haneda Terminal 3. They will drop you at the Marriott lobby (~30-40 mins).
 - **Dinner:** Walk **4 minutes** north to the **Tokyo Station Yaesu South Exit**. Enter and follow signs for "**Tokyo Ichibangai**" (**First Avenue**). Look for **Ramen Street**.
 - **The Meal:**
 - Rokurinsha for dipping style ramen "tsukemen",
 - Or
 - Tsuru Ton Tan BIS TOKYO for Udon
- **Side Attraction: Tokyo Character Street.** It's in the same basement. Your daughter can see the official Pokémon Center and Ghibli store immediately.
- **Transit:** Klook Limo transfer from Haneda to Hotel: TFK259132

May 28 (Thu): The Fish Market & The Anime Mecca

Plan of Attack: A high-protein morning at the market followed by a deep dive into Akihabara. You'll be moving through some of the most crowded stations, so we'll stick to simple lines.

Logistics:

- * **Morning:** Walk **15 minutes** south or take a 5-min taxi to [Tsukiji Outer Market](#)
- * **Lunch:** Walk to Age.3 Ginza for the famous fried bread with cream, then walk to Ginza Station
- * **To Akihabara:** From Ginza Station, take the **Hibiya Line (Gray)** to **Akihabara Station**. (10 mins, ¥180).
- * **The Target:** [Radio Kaikan \(Floors 4-6 Hatsune Miku\)](#) It's right outside the **Electric Town Exit**.
 - **Side Attraction: Kanda Myojin Shrine.** A 10-minute walk from the shops. It's the "geek shrine" where you can buy talismans for your electronics.
 - **Return Trip:** Take the **JR Yamanote Line (Green)** from Akihabara back to **Tokyo Station** (only 2 stops).
 - **First Train:** 4:30 AM | **Last Train:** 12:30 AM.
- * **Dinner:** Ichiran Shimbashi - Ginza Line (from **Kyobashi Station** to **Shimbashi Station**).

May 29 (Fri): Tokyo DisneySea (The Logistics Challenge)

Plan of Attack: DisneySea is legendary, but the transit is tricky. Even though you are "at" Tokyo Station, the Disney-bound platform is a **20-minute walk** *inside* the station.

- **Logistics:**
 - **Departure:** Leave the hotel by 7:30 AM. Walk to **Tokyo Station Yaesu South Exit**.
 - **Departure Location:** Tokyo Station, **Yaesu South Exit**, Bus Stop #1.
 - **Frequency:** Buses generally depart every **10 to 20 minutes** during the peak morning window (7:00 AM – 10:00 AM).
 - **Travel Time:** Approximately **35 minutes** to DisneySea.
 - **Meals at quick service, keep scoping out last minute reservations**
 - **Return Trip:**
 - **Disney Monorail to Maihama**
 - **Maihama Station**, board the **Keiyo Line** to Tokyo Station
 - The train back to Tokyo runs until midnight, but the park usually empties by 9:30 PM.
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May 30 (Sat): Harajuku Alternative & Shibuya Lights

Plan of Attack: Saturday in Harajuku is busy but essential for the "vibe." You'll hit the 3D coffee first to beat the 2-hour line, then shop for her goth/emo style.

- **Morning Logistics: Arrival and 3D Coffee Art - CAFE REISSUE**

Start your journey from Tokyo Station. Take the **JR Yamanote Line** (Outer Loop) directly to **Harajuku Station** (approx. 25–30 minutes). From there, it is a scenic 10-minute walk to CAFE REISSUE.

- **The Experience:** Show the barista a photo of Sadie Jane's favorite anime characters like Hatsune Miku, and watch them sculpt it in 3D foam.
- **Logistics:** Arrive by **9:45 AM** (15 minutes before their 10:00 AM opening) to beat the mid-morning queue.

Late Morning: Subculture Fashion & Iconic Sweets After coffee, walk about 6 minutes to the pedestrian-only Takeshita Street.



- **Shopping:** Visit ACDC RAG 原宿本店 for the "Yami Kawaii" and goth-punk styles Sadie Jane loves.
- **Dessert Hit:** Just a 1-minute walk away is Totti Candy Factory, famous for its massive, "Harajuku Rainbow" cotton candy that's larger than a child's umbrella.
- **Logistics:** Everything in this section is highly walkable within the Harajuku backstreets.

Lunch: The "Secret" Shibuya Katsudon

From Harajuku, take a 20-minute stroll south through the trendy Cat Street corridor to reach Katsudon-ya Zuicho.

- **The Dish:** A legendary counter-only spot serving a unique katsudon where the crispy pork is placed over the egg.
- **Logistics:** They open at 11:30 AM. Lines move fast, but arriving near opening is best.

Afternoon: Artistic Parfaits and Mega-Shopping After lunch, a deeper dive into Shibuya's fashion and dessert scenes.

- **Must-Hit Dessert:** Walk 17 minutes to INITIAL Omotesando. They specialize in "Shime Parfaits"—artistic, high-end desserts using seasonal fruits and Hokkaido cream that look like glass-encased sculptures.
- **Mega-Shopping:** Walk 15 minutes to Shibuya 109. This iconic 10-story tower is the epicenter of Japanese teen fashion, with entire floors dedicated to "alt" and anime-influenced styles.
- **Pop Culture:** If you have extra time, Shibuya Parco is nearby for the Nintendo and Pokemon stores.

Evening:

A taxi from Shibuya Parco to Nishiazabu will take about 10–15 minutes and cost roughly ¥1,500–¥2,000. It is a great way to rest your feet after a long day of walking.

The target - **Dinner: Yakitori Toriyoshi Nishiazabu** (Arrive ~6-6:15, 30 minute wait)

This is a polished, "grown-up" yakitori experience that trades the rowdiness of a standard bar for a focus on serious craftsmanship. It is an excellent fit if you want a high-end meal that still feels grounded and authentic.

- **Atmosphere:** It features a calm, minimalist aesthetic with a beautiful wooden counter. It is notably quieter and cleaner (smoke-free) than typical yakitori joints.
- While it feels sophisticated, it is welcoming to families. The "Omakase stop system" (where they keep bringing skewers until you say stop) can be a fun, interactive way for a teenager to try different cuts.

Return Logistics: A taxi directly from Nishiazabu to your hotel will take approximately 20 minutes and cost about ¥3,500.

May 31: The Master Knife, Pearls, and Digital Dreamscapes

Morning: Kappabashi Kitchen Town & Knife Shopping

- **Logistics:** Take the **Ginza Line (Yellow)** from Kyobashi Station to **Tawaramachi Station** (15 mins). Walk 5 minutes to the kitchen district.
- **The Knife:** Arrive by 10:00 AM at **Kama-Asa** to browse high-quality, handmade Damascus-style knives. Request your custom on-site engraving right away so it can be processed while you explore.

Lunch: Historic Asakusa

- **Logistics:** Walk 10 minutes east from Kappabashi into the heart of Asakusa.
- **The Meal:** Head to **Unatoto Asakusa** for their signature affordable, high-quality grilled eel (unagi) over rice.
- **The Sight:** Post-lunch, take a walk through **Senso-ji**, Tokyo's oldest temple complex. On your way back to the train, duck into the **Asakusa Underground Mall** at the Ginza Line entrance to see the 1950s time-capsule aesthetic.

Early Afternoon: Pearl Shopping in Ueno

- **Logistics (Asakusa to Ueno):** From Asakusa Station, take the **Ginza Line (Yellow)** 3 stops to **Inaricho Station** (3 mins). From Inaricho, it is a straightforward 5-minute walk

southwest to PEARL SEIWA in Higashiueno. *(Alternatively, you can take the Ginza Line to Ueno Station, but Inaricho Station drops you slightly closer to the shop's exact location).*

- **The Jewelry:** Arrive around **1:30 PM**. This gives you a solid hour to browse their collection of high-quality Japanese pearls and select jewelry for Sara without needing to rush.

Afternoon: Digital Art Immersion

- **Logistics (Ueno to Azabudai Hills):** Walk 6 minutes from the pearl shop over to **Ueno-okachimachi Station**. Board the **Hibiya Line (Gray)** and take it directly to **Kamiyacho Station** (approx. 20 mins, no transfers).
- **The Experience:** Arrive at **teamLab Borderless** in Azabudai Hills around 2:45 PM to check in for your **3:00 PM entry window**. Everything connects seamlessly underground from Kamiyacho Station; simply follow the internal signage for "Azabudai Hills."

Evening: High-End Wagyu Finale

- **Logistics:** Take the **Hibiya Line (Gray)** from Kamiyacho Station back toward **Ginza Station** (10 mins).
- **The Dinner:** Head to your celebratory dinner at **Oumi beef yakiniku Nikutatsu Ginza** for A5-ranked Wagyu served in private booth seating.
- **Side Attraction:** Before or after dinner, explore **Itoya**, the 12-story stationery department store, making sure to head to the top floor to view their indoor hydroponic farm.

Return:

- Walk 10 minutes back to the Courtyard by Marriott Tokyo Station.

June 1: Shinjuku Subcultures and Cosplay Adventures

A full day in Tokyo shifts to the neon-lit energy of Shinjuku, home to the world's busiest station and the "Godzilla" district of Kabukicho.

Late Morning: Urban Nature Take the **Marunouchi Line (Red)** from Tokyo Station to **Shinjuku-gyoemmae Station** (20 mins).

- **Activity:** Explore Shinjuku Gyoen National Garden. This massive park features traditional Japanese, French, and English gardens—a peaceful contrast to the Shinjuku skyline.

- **Logistics:** The park is a 5-minute walk from the station exit.

Lunch: The Alleys of Memory Walk 15 minutes toward Shinjuku Station's West Exit.

- **The Meal:** Find a spot in Omoide Yokochō Memory Lane, also known as "Piss Alley." It's a narrow grid of tiny stalls serving yakitori and ramen.
- **Logistics:** It is highly atmospheric and tucked right next to the train tracks; look for the green and red lanterns.

Afternoon: Godzilla and Gadgets Walk through Shinjuku Station to the East Side and enter Kabukicho.

- **The Landmark:** Look up to see the Godzilla Head looming over the Shinjuku Toho Building.
- **Shopping:** Spend time at Don Quijote Shinjuku Kabukicho, a multi-story "megastore" perfect for picking up unique snacks and souvenirs.

Evening: Cosplay Adventure Head to your **5:00 PM** check-in for the **120-Minutes Cosplay Adventure** near the Godzilla Head.

- **The Experience:** This guided walkthrough allows you to dress as anime characters—a highlight for any anime fan.
- **Logistics:** Since your reservation is in Kabukicho, you'll be in the heart of the action when you finish at 7:00 PM.

Dinner: Non-Smoking Dining in Kabukicho After your cosplay tour, head to a nearby dinner spot that avoids the heavy smoke often found in this district.

- Tsurutontan Shinjuku
 - This stylish udon brasserie is a 4-minute walk from the Godzilla Head. It offers a spacious, modern atmosphere that is entirely non-smoking (with a separate designated smoking room to keep the air clear in the dining area).
 - **Atmosphere:** It has a lively, "cool" vibe with occasional live music, making it feel like a night out while remaining very teenager-friendly.
 - **The Food:** They are famous for their massive "washbowl" sized bowls of udon, ranging from traditional flavors to creamy carbonara or curry versions.

Return Trip

Take the **Marunouchi Line** from Shinjuku Station directly back to Tokyo Station (20 mins) and walk back to the Courtyard by Marriott Tokyo Station.

June 2: The Anime Flagship and Sky-High Sunshine City

This alternative plan for your final day trades the coastal views of Ariake for the "Otome Road" and anime-centric energy of Ikebukuro. This neighborhood is the primary rival to Akihabara but with a much higher focus on character goods, themed cafes, and a smoke-free, indoor mega-complex.

Morning: The Anime Flagship Experience

**** FORWARD LUGGAGE TO OSAKA BY 10AM ****

Start your morning by taking the **Marunouchi Line** from Tokyo Station directly to **Ikebukuro Station** (approx. 20 minutes). From there, it's a 5-minute walk to the animate Ikebukuro Flagship Store.

- **The Experience:** This is the largest anime shop in the world. Spanning nine floors, it houses everything from manga and CDs to exclusive character merchandise and a theater.
- **Logistics:** It opens at 10:00 AM. Since it is the flagship, it often has exclusive "pop-up" shops and limited-edition items not found in their other branches.

Lunch: The Gyoza Stadium

Walk 6 minutes from Animate to the Sunshine 60 complex.

- **The Meal:** Head inside **Namjatown**, an indoor theme park on the 2nd floor, to visit the **Namja Gyoza Stadium**.
- **Details:** This is a collection of gyoza stalls from all over Japan. You can try "tasting plates" from different regions in one sitting. It's a fun, indoor, and non-smoking environment perfect for a casual lunch.

Afternoon: Mega-Shopping and Sky-High Views

Spend your afternoon exploring the vast Sunshine 60 complex, which is a city-within-a-city.

- **Pokémon Center Mega Tokyo & Pikachu Sweets:** This is one of the largest Pokemon Centers in the world. It also includes "Pikachu Sweets," a specialized dessert shop with character-themed cupcakes and lattes.
- **Studio Ghibli Shopping:** Visit the **Donguri Kyowakoku** shop within the mall for official Studio Ghibli merchandise, including high-quality items from *My Neighbor Totoro* and *Spirited Away*.
- **Sky-High Break:** If you want one last look at the city, the **Sunshine 60 Observatory Tenbou Park** offers a 360-degree view from 251 meters up, featuring indoor grassy areas and a cafe.

Evening: The Grand Seafood Finale

Take the **Yurakucho Line** from Higashi-Ikebukuro Station (connected to the mall) directly to **Ginza-itchome Station** (20 mins). A short walk brings you to your final dinner at Seafood Buffet Dining Ginza Happs.

- **The Meal:** Enjoy king crab, fresh sushi, and premium yakiniku in an elegant, smoke-free basement setting.

Return Trip

It is a 20-minute walk or a 5-minute taxi back to the Courtyard by Marriott Tokyo Station to prepare for your departure the next morning.

June 3 (Wed): The Mt. Fuji Shinkansen Run

Plan of Attack: This is the easiest travel day of your trip. You will board a direct bullet train to Osaka, purposefully seated for the best view of Japan's most famous mountain.

- **Logistics:**
 - **The Train:** Board the **Nozomi Shinkansen** at Tokyo Station bound for **Shin-Osaka**.
 - **Mt. Fuji Seating:** You MUST request **Seats E and D** (in a standard car) or **Seat E** (in a Green Car). These seats are on the right-hand side when traveling from Tokyo to Osaka, providing a clear view of Mt. Fuji approximately 45 minutes into the journey.
- **Side Attraction/Lunch before:** Godaime Hanayama Udon Ginza. If you have time before your train, this spot near Ginza is famous for its **extra-wide flat noodles** served in a traditional crane-shaped bowl. It opens at 11:00 AM.

TRAIN TO OSAKA DETAILS:

isfujivisible.com – will help determine if we'll see Fuji on the train ride or not - prioritize earlier trains and skip lunch **IF it's visible**.

While Nozomi trains run like clockwork, you specifically want **Seat E** (or D in Green Car) to see Mt. Fuji. These seats are the first to be snapped up. Since you're traveling on a Wednesday, you don't have to worry about holiday crowds, but booking a few days (or even weeks) ahead via the **SmartEX app** or website ensures you get those right-hand side window seats together.

The Trip to the Airport

Since your return flight is out of Haneda (HND), you'll likely be taking the Shinkansen from Shin-Osaka or Kyoto back to **Shinagawa Station** (which is the best transfer point for Haneda). Timing is everything when catching an international flight, so having a reserved seat means you aren't scrambling at the station with luggage.

The "Large Luggage" Rule: If your suitcases are large (total dimensions over 160cm), you are **required** to reserve a "Seat with Oversized Luggage Area." You cannot just walk onto the train with huge bags anymore without a specific reservation for those back-row seats.

The Westin Transit

- **The Shuttle Bus:** The Westin offers a **complimentary shuttle** between the hotel and the **JR Osaka Station (Sakurabashi Exit)**.
 - **Schedule:** Generally runs every **15–20 minutes** from 7:30 AM to 10:00 PM.
 - **Pickup Point:** At JR Osaka Station, look for the "High-Speed Bus Terminal" area near the Sakurabashi Exit.
 - **Walking Path:** If you miss the bus, it's a **10–12 minute walk** through the "Umeda Underground" or past the [Umeda Sky Building](#)
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June 3 (Wed): The Soul of Osaka & Dotonbori

Plan of Attack: After your Shinkansen arrives at Shin-Osaka, you'll head to the Westin to drop your bags. The evening is dedicated to the world-famous food scene of Dotonbori, where you'll practice "Kuidaore" (eating until you drop).

- **Logistics:**
 - **Arrival:** Shinkansen arrives at **Shin-Osaka Station**. Transfer to the **JR Kyoto Line** for one stop (4 mins) to **JR Osaka Station**.
 - **To Hotel:** Exit at the **Sakurabashi Exit** and catch the Westin Shuttle Bus.
 - **To Dotonbori:** Take the shuttle back to Osaka Station. Walk 2 minutes to **Umeda Station** (Subway) and take the **Midosuji Line (Red)** to **Namba Station** (¥240, 10 mins).
 - **Return:** Midosuji Line from Namba back to Umeda. **Last Train: ~12:00 AM.**
 - **The Meal:** Street food & shopping. **Wagyu Itaden for an amazing bento box!** Other options: **Mizuno** for Okonomiyaki and **Kukuru** for Takoyaki.
 - **Late Night:** Haunted Osaka Castle at 8PM - [GetYourGuide \(GYGG45XBK2NZ\)](#)
 - [3-1 Ōsakajō, Chuo Ward, Osaka, 540-0002, Japan](#)
 - Meet outside, the back exit of Starbucks at Jo- Terrace, located close to OsakaJoKoen station; the guide will be outside wearing a green backpack. When exiting OsakaJoKoen Station, the Starbucks is straight ahead.
 - **Side Attraction: Umeda Sky Building.** Since it is right next to your hotel, visit the **Kuchu Teien Observatory** for sunset. It closes at 10:00 PM.
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June 4 (Thu): Relaxing Day

Plan of Attack: Chill at hotel, food near hotel, omakase for dinner:

Lunch: GYUKATSU Kyoto Katsugyu Umeda - If you want a quintessential Japanese experience that isn't sushi, this spot specializes in deep-fried beef cutlets (gyukatsu).

- **Experience:** You get a high-quality cut of beef with a thin, crispy coating, which you can then sear to your liking on a personal stone grill at your table.
- **Teen-Friendly:** It's a fun, interactive meal that your daughter will likely enjoy for the "Instagrammable" factor of the sizzling beef.
- **Logistics:** About a 12-15 minute walk or a 5-minute taxi from the Westin, located in the basement level near Umeda Station.

Dinner: 2 Hour Omakase at Sushi Fukushima, Osaka. **6pm.** VIP Course.

June 5 (Fri): Kyoto Day Trip: Manga, Udon & Kiyamachi Nights

Plan of Attack: A specialized day focused on Kyoto's creative and culinary heart. You'll secure a custom manga portrait, enjoy artisan udon near the Silver Pavilion, and explore the historic shopping arcades and gyoza culture of the city center.

Departure from Osaka

- **Logistics:** Leave by 8:45am, take the Westin shuttle to Osaka Station. Board the **JR Special Rapid Service** bound for Kyoto (30 mins). From Kyoto Station, take the Karasuma Subway Line to **Karasuma Oike Station** (5 mins). Exit and walk 2 minutes to the museum.

Kyoto International Manga Museum

- **The Goal:** Arrive by 9:45 AM to be first in line. Head immediately to the "Manga Artist Corner" to sign up for the **Manga Portrait** list.
- **The Experience:** While waiting for your portrait, browse the "Wall of Manga" featuring 50,000 volumes or relax in the outdoor courtyard, which often hosts manga-related events.

Transit to Lunch (Omen Ginkaku-ji)

- **Logistics:** The most efficient way to maintain your schedule is a 15-minute taxi directly to the restaurant (GO App). Alternatively, walk back to the main road and take **City Bus #32 or #203** to the Ginkakuji-michi stop.



- **The Meal:** Experience artisan udon served with a signature platter of seasonal condiments, including ginger, sesame, and Kyoto vegetables.

Afternoon Shopping & Exploration

- **Logistics:** Take **City Bus #5 or #203** from the Ginkakuji area back toward the city center (Shijo-Kawaramachi area).
 - **Nishiki Market:** Explore the "Kitchen of Kyoto" for high-quality kitchenware and specialized food souvenirs like Aritsugu knives or Kyoto spices.
 - **Teramachi Shopping Street:** Transition into this covered arcade for traditional woodblock prints, fine stationery, and tea merchants.
 - **Ninenzaka:** If time allows, take a short taxi to this historic district to see the preserved wooden architecture before dinner.

Dinner at Chao Chao Gyoza - Sanjo Kiyamachi

- **Logistics:** Walk from the Teramachi/Nishiki area to the Kiyamachi district (approx. 10 mins).
- **The Meal:** Enjoy award-winning, bite-sized "hitokuchi" gyoza. They offer unique varieties like shrimp, ginger, and curry-flavored gyoza.

Return to Osaka

- **Logistics:** Walk 15 minutes to Kyoto Station or take the subway from nearby Sanjo Station. Catch the **JR Special Rapid** back to Osaka Station.
- **Last Train Info:** The final **Special Rapid** departs at **11:29 PM**. Local trains run until approximately **12:14 AM**.

Late Night in Osaka

- **24-Hour Ramen:** ICHIRAN Umeda Hankyu Higashidori is open until 6:00 AM (approx. 15-min walk from the hotel).
 - **Conveyor Belt Sushi:** Kura Sushi Umeda OS Building is open until **Midnight** for a final snack.
 - **Quick Stop:** Grab late-night snacks at the 7-Eleven Heart-in located at the station exit near your shuttle pick-up point.
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June 6 (Sat): Kobe Beef & Osaka Craftsmanship

Plan of Attack: A luxury lunch in Kobe followed by a return to Osaka for a dedicated shopping excursion. You'll explore the retro vibes of Shinsekai and end the night with high-end sushi.

11:00 AM – Departure for Kobe

- **Logistics:** Take the Westin shuttle to Osaka Station. Board the **JR Special Rapid Service** bound for Himeji/Aboshi and get off at **Sannomiya Station** (approx. 22 mins). From there, it is a 5-minute walk to the restaurant.

Lunch at Kobe Beef Steak Ishida.Main-Shop

- **The Meal:** As a dedicated "foodie," this is your locked-in Kobe experience. They specialize in high-grade (A5) Kobe beef prepared Teppanyaki-style right in front of you.

Return to Osaka & Craft Shopping

- **Logistics:** Take the **JR Special Rapid** back to Osaka Station, then transfer to the **Midosuji Subway Line** (Red) to **Namba Station**. Walk 10 minutes south to reach "Kitchenware Street."
- **Sennichimae Doguyasuji Shopping Street:** This is where you will find the "super sharp, hand made" knives you're looking for.
 - **Sakai Ichimonji Mitsuhide:** Visit this boutique maker for Damascus-style blades. They offer on-site engraving, so you can have your name or the date added to your knife as a permanent souvenir.

Shopping for Sadie

- **Logistics:** From Doguyasuji, it's a 15-minute walk or a quick subway hop to the Shinsaibashi area.
- **Amerikamura (Amemura):** This is the heart of Osaka's youth culture and the perfect spot for Sadie's "emo-goth-anime" style.
 - **Volcan & Aphrodite:** Highly recommended for her specific taste—expect bold graphic tees, alternative silhouettes, and pops of color that fit the "Hot Topic" aesthetic she likes.

Shinsekai Immersion

- **Logistics:** Take the Midosuji Line from Shinsaibashi to **Dobutsuen-mae Station** (5 mins).
- **Tsutenkaku:** Head to the observation deck for a view of the city, or try the "Tower Slider," a 60-meter long slide that spirals down the outside of the tower.
- **Retro Gaming:** Spend some time at **Kasuga Goraku-jo**, a vintage arcade that perfectly captures the "retro-future" look often discussed in conspiracy theory circles and tech podcasts.

Dinner: The Sushi Strategy

Since availability is tight, we are moving to a two-tier approach for your evening meal:

- **Tier 1: The Omakase.in Monitoring List:** Keep an eye on these spots for cancellations. They represent the peak of Osaka's "omakase" scene:

* Sushi Oga, Sushiya Yohei, Sushi Harasho, and Sushi Saeki KitaWard Osaka. These are all top-tier and often have last-minute openings due to travel changes.

- **Tier 2: The Traditional Backup:** If omakase doesn't open up, head to **Kame Sushi Sohonten** in the Umeda area.
 - This is a legendary, high-energy traditional sushi house. It's not a quiet omakase, but the quality of the fish is world-class, and it's a favorite for "foodies" who want authentic, high-end nigiri without the formal reservation stress.

Return to the Westin

- **Logistics:** From the Namba/Umeda area, take the **Midosuji Line** (Red) back to **Umeda Station**.
- **Frequency:** Trains run every 4–6 minutes.
- **Last Train:** The final Midosuji train departs around **11:50 PM**.
- **Final Leg:** From Osaka/Umeda Station, you can catch the final Westin shuttle (typically until 10:00 PM) or take a 15-minute walk/5-minute taxi back to The Westin Osaka

June 7 (Sun): Second Kyoto Day

Plan of Attack: Today is a high-speed, high-reward day combining viral food, aesthetic photography, and boutique shopping. Your absolute priority is locking down the Kichi Kichi Omurice same-day reservation first thing in the morning from your hotel room. Once secured for lunch, you will transfer to Kyoto to wander through a hidden-gem, vertical shopping alley, explore the traditional covered craft arcades, take in river views, and hunt for handmade Japanese knives before catching an express train back to Osaka by late afternoon to prepare for your evening food tour.

Train Times & Directions for Getting to Kyoto

Because you are staying at The Westin Osaka, your most efficient path avoids the Shinkansen entirely (which forces you to Shin-Osaka and drops you at Kyoto Station, quite far south of the action). Instead, use the **Hankyu Kyoto Line**, which takes you straight into central Kyoto (Kyoto-Kawaramachi Station), right where your lunch and shopping are located.

- **Depart:** ~9:30 AM or 10:00 AM (depending on your exact lunch slot).
- **Route:**
 1. Walk 10–12 minutes from the hotel to **Osaka-Umeda Station**.
 2. Board the **Hankyu Kyoto Line - Limited Express (特急)** bound for Kyoto-Kawaramachi.
 3. Ride to the final stop: **Kyoto-Kawaramachi Station**.
- **Travel Time:** ~45 minutes.
- **Cost:** ¥410 per person.

Navigate Around Kyoto (Securing Kichi Kichi)

Kichi Kichi utilizes a **strict same-day online booking system**. To secure a lunch slot, follow this battle plan:

- **9:00 AM SHARP:** Open the official Kichi Kichi booking page on your device.
- **The Process:** Select a lunchtime window between 11:40 AM and 2:00 PM. Do not refresh if it lags—the site handles immense traffic instantly.
- **Navigation:** Once your slot is confirmed, you will walk directly from Kyoto-Kawaramachi Station. Kichi Kichi is tucked into a narrow alley in the Zaimokucho area, a 7-minute walk north of the station. **Crucial:** You must arrive at least **20 minutes before your time slot** to line up on the red line outside; if you are late, they immediately give your counter seats to physical walk-ins.

Scenic Walks & Shopping (Non-Higashiyama / Non-Gion)

Since you are bypassing the massive crowds of Kiyomizudera and Gion today, focus on these highly photogenic, boutique-heavy areas all within a tight, walkable radius of your lunch spot:

Pontocho Alley & The Kamogawa Riverfront

- **The Vibe:** Pontocho is a breathtakingly narrow, atmospheric alley running parallel to the Kamo River. While famous for evening nightlife, walking it in the late morning offers clean, crowd-free shots of traditional wooden machiya architecture and lanterns.

Afterward, step out onto the banks of the Kamo River for iconic, wide-angle scenic shots.

- **Photo Op:** The framed geometric perspective looking down the ultra-narrow stone alleyways.

Teramachi & Shinkyogoku Shopping Arcades

- **The Vibe:** Running parallel to each other, these historic covered pedestrian avenues seamlessly blend ultra-modern Japanese street culture with centuries-old craft legacy. It's vibrant, neon-lit, and sheltered, offering a massive contrast to traditional temple districts.
- **Shopping Focus:** This area is excellent for hunting high-quality, handmade Japanese knives. You can visit legacy shops like **Aritsugu** (located just off the arcade in Nishiki) to browse boutique Damascus-pattern blades and get custom name-engravings done on the spot.

Furukawacho Shopping Arcade (The "Retro" Arcade)

- **The Vibe:** Located just a brief walk across the river, this is a beautifully nostalgic, quiet shopping street famous for its canopy of colorful lanterns hanging from the ceiling. It gives an incredible "Showa-era vintage Japan" aesthetic that is massively popular on Instagram but gets a fraction of the mainstream tourist traffic.
- **Photo Op:** Standing dead-center under the floating colored lanterns.

Transit Back to Osaka

To comfortably make your 7:00 PM food tour, you need to step through the doors of your hotel room by 5:00 PM to freshen up.

- **Target Departure Time:** Board the train at Kyoto-Kawaramachi no later than **3:45 PM**.
- **Route:**
 1. Walk back to **Kyoto-Kawaramachi Station**.
 2. Board the **Hankyu Kyoto Line Limited Express** returning to Osaka-Umeda.
 3. From Osaka-Umeda Station, walk back to the hotel.

Evening Tasting in Osaka

- **7:00 PM** – *The 10 Tastings of Osaka* with **Fay** (WithLocals App booking)
- **Booking Reference:** **7D89B827**
- *Pending meeting point details.*

June 8 (Mon): Alternative Culture & Shinsaibashi Style

Plan of Attack: A full immersion into Osaka's youth subcultures. You'll spend the day browsing vintage stores and anime boutiques in Amemura before transitioning to the massive shopping arcades of Shinsaibashi and ending with a historic Osaka-style unagi dinner.

Arrival at American Village (Amemura)

- **Logistics:** Take the Westin shuttle to Osaka Station. Board the **Midosuji Line** (Red) south to **Shinsaibashi Station** (6 mins). Use Exit 7 or 8.
- **The Experience:** Start at **Sankaku Koen (Triangle Park)**, the epicenter of Osaka street fashion.
- **Sadie's Shopping:**

* **Alice On Wednesday:** A boutique themed after *Alice in Wonderland* with a "goth-cute" aesthetic.

* **Mandarake Grand Chaos Shop:** A multi-story temple for "otaku" culture, featuring rare anime figures and alternative subculture goods.

Lunch in Amemura

- **Logistics:** Both options are within a 5-minute walk of Triangle Park.
 - **Red Rock Amemura:** Famous for their viral "Roast Beef Don"—a towering mountain of thinly sliced beef over rice topped with creamy yogurt sauce and a raw egg yolk.
 - **Critters Burger:** Widely considered one of the best gourmet burger spots in Osaka, using high-quality Japanese beef and artisanal buns in a relaxed, American-style diner.

Shinsaibashi-Suji Shopping Street

- **Logistics:** Walk 5 minutes east from Amemura to cross over the Midosuji boulevard into the covered arcade.
- **The Experience:** Explore nearly a mile of shopping, from global brands like Uniqlo to unique Japanese boutiques.
- **Sadie's Highlights:** Look for the **Sanrio Gallery** for character-focused goods or the massive multi-story drugstores for viral Japanese skincare and alternative makeup styles.

Dinner at Yoshitora

- **Logistics:** From Shinsaibashi-Suji Shopping Street, take the **Midosuji Line** north one stop to **Honmachi Station** (2 mins). Use Exit 12 and walk 5 minutes.
- **The Meal:** Yoshitora is the premier alternative for Osaka-style unagi.
- **What to Order:** Request their signature grilled eel. Osaka-style unagi is grilled directly over charcoal without being steamed first, resulting in a crispier skin and a richer, more concentrated flavor that "foodies" specifically travel for.

Return to The Westin Osaka

- **Logistics:** Walk back to **Honmachi Station**. Take the **Midosuji Line** north two stops to **Umeda Station** (4 mins).
 - **Train Frequency:** Trains arrive every **4 to 6 minutes**.
 - **Last Train:** The final Midosuji train from Honmachi toward Umeda departs at approximately **12:06 AM**.
-

June 9 (Tue): To Haneda

The Direct Path to Haneda Airport - Leave around 11AM

The most efficient route is via the Shinkansen (Bullet Train) followed by a quick transfer in Tokyo.

- **Step 1:** Take the Westin shuttle or a taxi to Osaka Station. Take a local JR train (4 mins) to **Shin-Osaka Station**.
- **Step 2:** Board the **Tokaido Shinkansen (Nozomi)** from Shin-Osaka to **Shinagawa Station** in Tokyo (approx. 2 hours 15 mins).
- **Step 3:** At Shinagawa, transfer to the **Keikyu Airport Line** (Airport Ltd. Exp.) directly to **Haneda Airport Terminal 3 Station** (approx. 13 mins).

Accommodation: The Royal Park Hotel Tokyo Haneda

This is the hotel located directly within the Terminal 3 departure level (3rd Floor). You can walk straight from the hotel lobby to the check-in counters.

- *Note: Hotel Villa Fontaine Premier Haneda-Airport is also connected to Terminal 3 via Haneda Airport Garden, offering a more luxury-oriented experience with a rooftop spa.*

Tickets & Seat Recommendations

- **Where to Book:** Use the **SmartEX app** (which you mentioned using for your trip planning). It allows you to book and change seats on your iPhone.
- **Seat Choice:** Request **Seats D and E** on the Nozomi train. On a clear day, these are

the seats that offer a view of **Mount Fuji** on your left as you head toward Tokyo.

The Bento Box Lunch

You should pick up your "Ekiben" (station bento) at **Shin-Osaka Station** before boarding the Shinkansen.

- **Ekiben Nigiwai:** Located inside the Eki Marché at Shin-Osaka, this shop has a massive selection of regional bentos from all over Japan. Look for the "Kobe Beef" or "Osaka-style" bento boxes to enjoy during your 2-hour ride.

Luggage Strategy

Traveling with multiple bags on the train can be cumbersome.

- **Takkyubin (Luggage Delivery):** I highly recommend using a luggage forwarding service from The Westin Osaka. You can drop your large bags at the bell desk on June 8th, and they will be delivered directly to your Haneda hotel by the afternoon of June 9th.
- **Shinkansen Oversize Baggage:** If you choose to carry them, remember that the Shinkansen requires a specific "**Baggage Reservation**" for suitcases over a certain size (usually anything larger than a standard carry-on). You can select these specific seats in the SmartEX app.
- **Dinner: Haneda Airport Garden.** A massive complex connected to the terminal with dozens of high-end food options.